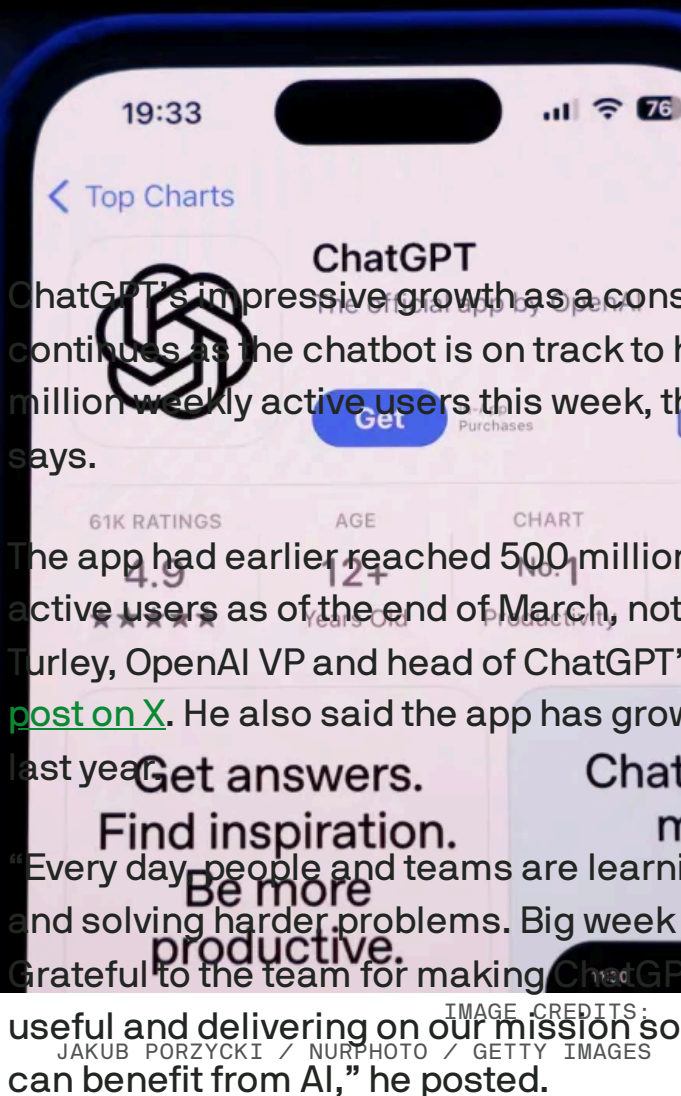


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AI



OpenAI says ChatGPT is
on track to reach 700M
weekly users



ChatGPT's impressive growth as a consumer app continues as the chatbot is on track to hit 700 million weekly active users this week, the company says.

The app had earlier reached 500 million weekly active users as of the end of March, noted Nick Turley, OpenAI VP and head of ChatGPT's app, [in a post on X](#). He also said the app has grown 4x since last year.

“Every day, people and teams are learning, creating, and solving harder problems. Big week ahead. Grateful to the team for making ChatGPT more useful and delivering on our mission so everyone can benefit from AI,” he posted.

The app's popularity increased after OpenAI launched an [upgraded image-generation feature](#), powered by the GPT-4 model, in March. In early April, the company's COO, Brad Lightcap, said that more than [130 million users had created over 700 million images](#) in just a few days after the launch.

The company has also seen an increase in subscribers. Last week, Lightcap said that ChatGPT had [5 million paying business users](#), up from 3 million in June.

In a recent report, market intelligence firm Sensor Tower noted that users are using [ChatGPT for more than 12 days a month on average](#), only behind Google and X. The report also said that in H1 2025,

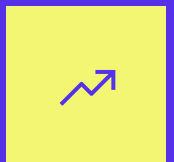
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users spent an average of 16 minutes per day on the app.

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Ivan covers global consumer tech developments at TechCrunch. He is based out of India and has previously...

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AI



OpenAI's ChatGPT now has 100 million weekly active users

OPENAI DEV

ChatGPT now has 100 million weekly active users, OpenAI CEO Sam Altman announced on Monday at the company's first developer conference in San Francisco. The service released nearly a year ago and garnered [an estimated 100 million](#) monthly users within just two months of launching and set a record for fastest-growing user base.

Altman also shared today that over two million developers use the platform, including more than 92% of Fortune 500 companies.

The company revealed the new milestones as it shared a series of new announcements. OpenAI unveiled [GPT-4 Turbo](#), which is a "more powerful" and less expensive version of its flagship text-generating AI model, [GPT-4](#).

OpenAI also [announced GPTs](#), a way for anyone to build their own version of the conversational AI system. The company will soon also give users the ability to publish their own versions of the system on a marketplace called the "GPT Store," and possibly earn some money by doing so.

In addition, the company announced that [DALL-E 3](#), OpenAI's text-to-image model, [is now available](#) via an API after first coming to [ChatGPT](#) and [Bing Chat](#). Interestingly, OpenAI is launching a new API, called the Assistants API, that will help developers build "agent-like experiences" within their apps. With this API, developers will be able to build an "assistant" that leverages outside knowledge and can call OpenAI generative AI models and tools to perform tasks.

Plus, the company is [introducing](#) a text-to-speech API that offers six preset voices to choose from and

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two generative AI model variants.

[OpenAI debuts GPT-4 Turbo and fine-tuning program for GPT-4](#)

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OpenAI debuts GPT-4o
'omni' model now
powering ChatGPT

GPT-4o

OpenAI announced a new flagship generative AI model on Monday that they call GPT-4o — the “o” stands for “omni,” referring to the model’s ability to handle text, speech, and video. GPT-4o is set to roll out “iteratively” across the company’s developer and consumer-facing products over the next few weeks.

OpenAI CTO Mira Murati said that GPT-4o provides “GPT-4-level” intelligence but improves on GPT-4’s capabilities across multiple modalities and media.

“GPT-4o reasons across voice, text and vision,” Murati said during a streamed presentation at OpenAI’s offices in San Francisco on Monday. “And this is incredibly important, because we’re looking at the future of interaction between ourselves and machines.”

[GPT-4 Turbo](#), OpenAI’s previous “leading “most advanced” model, was trained on a combination of images and text and could analyze images and text to accomplish tasks like extracting text from images or even describing the content of those images. But GPT-4o adds speech to the mix.

What does this enable? A variety of things.

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IMAGE CREDITS: OPENAI

GPT-4o greatly improves the experience in OpenAI’s AI-powered chatbot, [ChatGPT](#). The platform has long offered a [voice mode](#) that transcribes the chatbot’s responses using a text-to-speech model, but GPT-4o supercharges this, allowing users to interact with ChatGPT more like an assistant.

For example, users can ask the GPT-4o-powered ChatGPT a question and interrupt ChatGPT while it’s answering. The model delivers “real-time” responsiveness, OpenAI says, and can even pick up on nuances in a user’s voice, in response generating voices in “a range of different emotive styles” (including singing).

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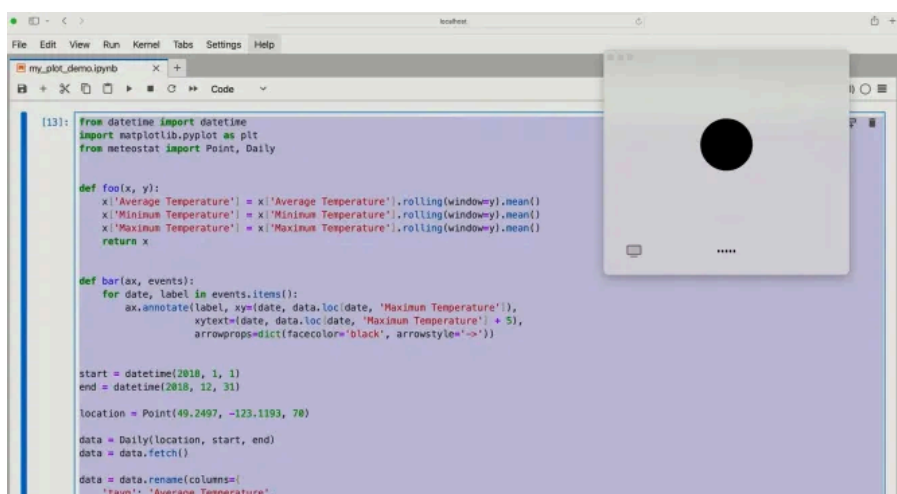
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GPT-4o also upgrades ChatGPT’s vision capabilities. Given a photo — or a desktop screen — ChatGPT can now quickly answer related questions, from topics ranging from “What’s going on in this software code?” to “What brand of shirt is this person wearing?”



CHATGPT’S DESKTOP APP IN USE IN A CODING TASK.

IMAGE CREDITS: OPENAI

These features will evolve further in the future, Murati says. While today GPT-4o can look at a picture of a menu in a different language and translate it, in the future, the model could allow ChatGPT to, for instance, “watch” a live sports game and explain the rules to you.

“We know that these models are getting more and more complex, but we want the experience of interaction to actually become more natural, easy, and for you not to focus on the UI at all, but just focus on the collaboration with ChatGPT,” Murati

said. “For the past couple of years, we’ve been very focused on improving the intelligence of these models ... But this is the first time that we are really making a huge step forward when it comes to the ease of use.”

GPT-4o is more multilingual as well, OpenAI claims, with enhanced performance in around 50 languages. And in OpenAI’s API and [Microsoft’s Azure OpenAI Service](#), GPT-4o is twice as fast as, half the price of and has higher rate limits than GPT-4 Turbo, the company says.

At present, voice isn’t a part of the GPT-4o API for all customers. OpenAI, citing the risk of misuse, says that it plans to first launch support for GPT-4o’s new audio capabilities to “a small group of trusted partners” in the coming weeks.

GPT-4o is available in the free tier of ChatGPT starting today and to subscribers to OpenAI’s premium ChatGPT [Plus](#) and [Team](#) plans with “5x higher” message limits. (OpenAI notes that ChatGPT will automatically switch to [GPT-3.5](#), an older and less capable model, when users hit the rate limit.) The improved ChatGPT voice experience underpinned by GPT-4o will arrive in alpha for Plus users in the next month or so, alongside [enterprise-focused options](#).

In related news, OpenAI announced that it’s releasing a refreshed ChatGPT UI on the web with a new, “more conversational” home screen and message layout, and a desktop version of ChatGPT for macOS that lets users ask questions via a keyboard shortcut or take and discuss screenshots. ChatGPT Plus users will get access to the app first, starting today, and a Windows version will arrive later in the year.

Elsewhere, the [GPT Store](#), OpenAI’s library of and creation tools for third-party chatbots built on its AI

models, is now available to users of ChatGPT’s free tier. And free users can take advantage of ChatGPT features that were formerly paywalled, like a [memory capability](#) that allows ChatGPT to “remember” preferences for future interactions, upload files and photos, and search the web for answers to timely questions.

We’re launching an AI newsletter! Sign up [here](#) to start receiving it in your inboxes on June 5.



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Kyle Wiggers was TechCrunch’s AI Editor until June 2025. His writing has appeared in VentureBeat and Digital Trend...

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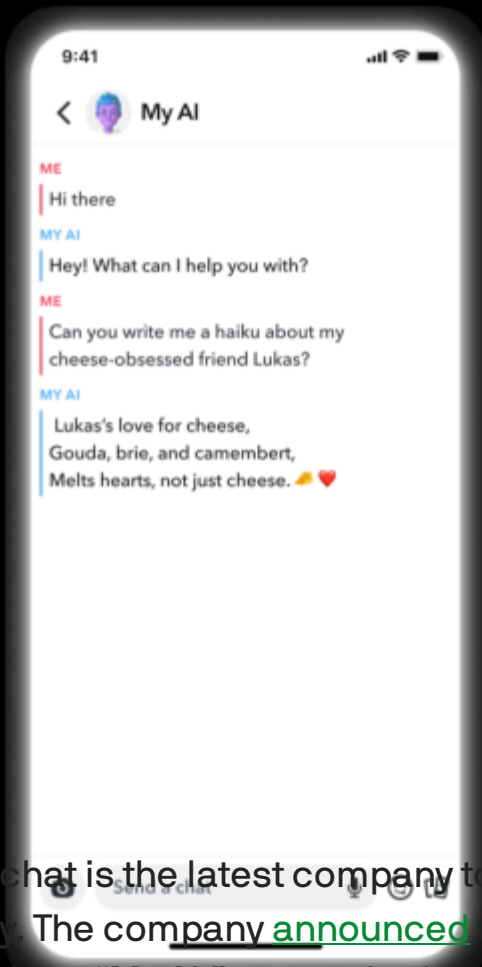
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SOCIAL



Snapchat launches an AI chatbot powered by OpenAI's GPT technology

Aisha Malik — 6:57 AM PST · February 27, 2023



Snapchat is the latest company to get in on the AI frenzy. The company announced today that it's launching "My AI," a new chatbot running the latest version of OpenAI's GPT technology that it has customized for its users. My AI is now available as an experimental feature for Snapchat+, the social network's \$3.99 a month subscription service.

IMAGE CREDITS: SNAPCHAT

The new chatbot will be pinned to the top of the Chat tab. My AI can do things like help answer a trivia question or write a haiku. My AI was trained to have a unique voice and personality that plays into its values about "friendship, learning and fun." It has also been trained to adhere to the app's trust and safety guidelines.

"My AI can recommend birthday gift ideas for your BFF, plan a hiking trip for a long weekend, suggest a recipe for dinner, or even write a haiku about cheese for your cheddar-obsessed pal," the company wrote in a blog post. "Make My AI your own by giving it a name and customizing the wallpaper for your Chat."

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Snapchat notes that “as with all AI-powered chatbots,” My AI can be tricked into saying just about anything. The company seems to be alluding [to the mess](#) created by Microsoft’s Bing, which was recently [updated with OpenAI’s GPT-4 model](#). A week into the launch, people started posting strange and unnerving responses that they received from the search engine, after which [Microsoft admitted](#) that Bing can be provoked to respond outside of its “designed tone.” Snapchat appears to be getting ahead of dealing with a similar situation with its own chatbot, noting that My AI has “many deficiencies.” Snapchat even went so far as saying “sorry in advance” to users of the new chatbot.

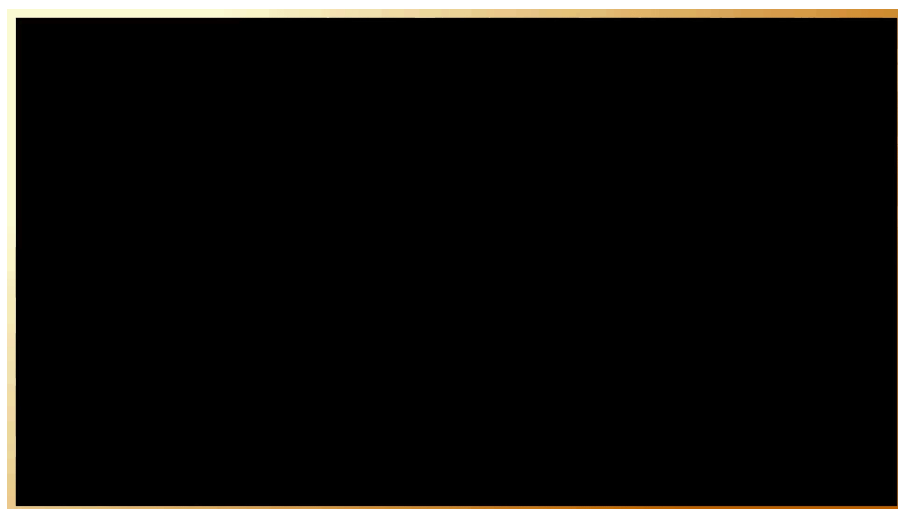


IMAGE CREDITS: SNAPCHAT

It’s worth noting that unlike Microsoft’s vision with Bing, Snapchat’s My AI isn’t meant to act as a search engine. It’s instead seen as a persona within Snapchat that you can chat with like you would with your friends.

All conversations with My AI will be stored and may be reviewed to improve the product’s experience. Snapchat also says that users shouldn’t share any secrets with My AI or rely on the chatbot for advice. The company says that although My AI is designed to avoid biased, incorrect, harmful or misleading information, mistakes may occur. The social network invites users to submit feedback by pressing and holding on any message from My AI.

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Since its launch a few months ago, Open AI's ChatGPT has dominated the internet and become increasingly popular. As a result, AI has become an increasingly trending topic over the past few months. Given these factors, it's not surprising that Snapchat is adding an AI chatbot to its own messaging platform.

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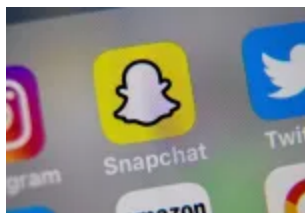
Of course, given that Snapchat caters to a young user base, the idea of safety is pretty important. Snapchat notes that the chatbot has been designed

to avoid harmful or misleading topics, and won't provide responses in these circumstances.

“Our app reaches 750 million people per month, with 75% of 13- to 34-year-olds in over 20 countries,” the company notes in the blog post. “Incorporating this technology into Snapchat’s messaging platform has the potential to make these interactions with AI part of what draws our community to Snapchat.”

Snapchat says it believes that over time, AI can be incredibly additive to the app’s experience, while also helping to foster deeper connections. In the short term, My AI may boost the company’s paid subscriber numbers, which [recently surpassed](#) the two million mark.

Snapchat announces 750M monthly active users



At its Investor Day event on Thursday, Snap shared a handful of new metrics about its business and teased its prospects. Notably, it said its social media app Snapchat has now grown to over 750 million monthly active users. While the

number falls far short of the roughly 2.96 billion monthly active users Facebook reported [Continue reading](#)

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